

Top Ten Résumé Tips

1. Target your résumé to the employer's needs and to the position you are seeking. Make sure to save each résumé with a name that identifies which position you tweaked it to apply for.
2. Remember “key words,” which will be identified by electronic scanning systems/Applicant Tracking Systems. Copy and paste the job description into www.freewordcloudgenerator.com to find the words used most often in the job description. These are potentially the words the employer will have the ATS scan for on your résumé. See page 2 for more ATS tips.
3. Present the most **recent** and **relevant** information first. Employers usually spend less than 7 seconds skimming a résumé! Draw attention to the degree you are seeking (or have earned) and your job title by **bolding** these items. It is more important what you are studying and what your job title is than where you went to school or worked.
4. List “Relevant Coursework” if you do not have relevant work experience.
5. Remember that appearance and format are initially more important than content. If your résumé is too long or not visually appealing, the employer may not read it.
6. Use action phrases, not complete sentences, to list your job duties. Remember to watch your verb tense.
 - Provide customer service (if currently still working at job)
 - Operated cash register (if no longer working at job)
7. Use specific examples or statistics whenever possible to demonstrate your accomplishments. For example: Increased monthly sales by \$10,000 or 17%
8. Pay careful attention to spelling, grammar, and punctuation! Details matter!
9. Include participation in clubs, associations, community, and volunteer organizations. “Activities” can be an excellent source of additional experience.
10. Be sure to contact your references and ask for permission to use them before listing them on your reference page. Your reference page should be a different document than the résumé, but with the same contact information and style as your résumé.



ATS-FRIENDLY RESUME DESIGN CHECKLIST

Follow these guidelines to make sure your resume scans correctly in ATS Systems and gets through to a human decision-maker!

SECTIONS

KEEP THE LAYOUT SIMPLE

- NO TABLES OR CHARTS
- ONLY ONE COLUMN
- STANDARD SECTION HEADINGS ("Summary of Qualifications," "Education")
- 1" MARGINS ALL THE WAY AROUND

VISUALS

DON'T CLOG THE MACHINE

- NO PICTURES OR GRAPHICS OF ANY KIND
- NO INFO IN VISUALS
- NO LOGOS THAT INTERRUPT TEXT
- STANDARD ROUND BULLETS

TEXT

MAKE TEXT SCANNABLE

- NO MORE THAN TWO READABLE FONTS
- DO NOT USE ABBREVIATIONS
- USE KEY WORDS/PHRASES FROM JOB DESCRIPTION
- NO UNDERLINING: this includes any kind of line on the page, vertical or horizontal

FILE FORMAT

SAVE IT CORRECTLY

- WORD VERSION
- PDF VERSION
- NO OTHER VERSIONS (Plain Text, Pages, Etc..)